SIX-BANDED ARMADILLO

Euphractus sexcinctus

USDA FEDERALLY LICENSED

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UNITED STATES DEPT. OF AGRI.

This animal is a teacher, not an attraction.

The keeper guides.
You observe. Do not touch.

Cameras in use. Federal penalties apply.

What can it see, hear, or feel?
Its long nose smells food under the soil, and long hairs on its shell feel what it brushes past.

Where does it live — and why?
It lives in open grassy places, where soft soil is easy to dig into for burrows.

How does it send messages?
It hisses and snorts when it feels cornered, and stamps its front feet near food.

What does it do when something changes?
When startled, it runs fast for its burrow or digs itself into the soil in seconds.

How does it learn?
Young follow their mother, learn which soil is easy to dig, and practice making small holes.

How does it have babies?
A mother has one to three babies, with soft shells that turn hard as they grow.

What are its limits?
Hard rocky ground or a long drought takes away the burrows and food it needs.

What does this teach us?
Eating many kinds of food helps an animal live where picky eaters cannot.

Think About This:

If you could eat nearly anything you find, how would that change where you choose to live?

Verification Door

Why does a six-banded armadillo dig its own burrow and eat many kinds of food?

Making its own shelter and eating almost anything it finds lets it live where pickier animals cannot.

What a living thing can sense becomes its reality.
Environment shapes design.